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NORTHFIELD HEALTH

Regional Payer Prior Authorization Escalation Standard

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Section 3.1 Scope

This standard applies to prior authorization requests submitted electronically by contracted hospitals for commercial and Medicare Advantage members.

Section 3.2.1 Urgent requests

For urgent or life-affecting prior authorization requests, the determination deadline is strictly 72 hours (3 calendar days) from initial electronic portal submission. Exceeding 72 hours triggers mandatory administrative escalation and provisional coverage authorization.

Section 3.2.2 Standard requests

For non-urgent requests the determination deadline is 7 calendar days from submission.

Section 3.3 Provider obligations

The ordering provider must upload the supporting clinical documentation within 24 hours of an urgent request. The 72 hour clock starts at submission, not when the hospital coordinator first reviews the request.

Section 3.4 Appeals

A denied urgent request may be appealed within 14 calendar days. A hospital may not hold an urgent request internally in order to delay notifying the ordering physician.